We hear the terms related to measurement like weight, kilogram, litres, millilitres, kilometre, length, distance etc. In this chapter let's study in detail about length, mass and time and the necessity to measure them.

1.1 Length

What is length? The distance between one point and the other desired point is known as length. It may be the distance between the edges of your book or the corners of the football ground in your school or even from your home to school.

The standard unit of length is 'metre'. It is represented by the letter 'm'. Very small lengths can be measured in millimetre (mm) and centimetre (cm). Larger measures, say height of a building, length of a banner or height of a lamp post are all measured in metre. How to express still longer lengths say, distance between two cities or villages or distance between your school and home? It is expressed in kilometre (km).

Know the unit of length

1 km (kilometre) = 1000 m (metre)
1 m (metre) = 100 cm (centimetre)
1 cm (centimetre) = 10 mm (millimetre)

Think: Can you express 1 km in cm?

Let us measure the length of your pencil.

1. Take the meter scale
2. Notice the lines with marking 1,2,3,4 ... till 15 (for smaller scales) or 30 (bigger scales). The distance between two numbers (say between 1 and 2) denotes a centimetre (written as 'cm').

